

EASTERN MEDITERRANEAN UNIVERSITY
Faculty of Business And Economics
Department of Political Science and International Relations
2023-24 Academic Year
Spring Semester

COURSE CODE AND TITLE	: PSIR172 – Applied Skills for Political Science & International Relations
COURSE LEVEL	: First Year
COURSE TYPE	: Area Core
LECTURER	: Oğuz Ufuk Haksever, PhD(c) Research Assistant
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CREDIT VALUE	: 3 Credit hrs.
ECTS VALUE	: 6 credits
PREREQUISITES	: None
DURATION OF COURSE	: One semester
WEB LINK	: All course-related correspondence and course notes will be available on Moodle from lms.emu.edu.tr and MS Teams.
OFFICE LOCATION	: Faculty of Business and Economics / BE 176
OFFICE HOURS	: Tuesday: 13.30-15.20 and Thursday: 11.30-12.20
READINGS	: Compulsory reading materials are available on LMS Moodle and MS Teams. There is no single textbook for this course. Reading(s) for each week is assigned from various sources and available in the weekly course schedule.
CLASS SCHEDULE	: Tuesday 10.30 – 12.20 / BEA-7 Thursday 10.30 – 11.20 / BEA-1

CATALOG DESCRIPTION

This course aims to ensure that students are prepared to pursue and complete a degree in the disciplines of Political Science and International Relations by serving to develop their ability to conduct university-level research and essay writing, develop skills such as public speaking, working in a team environment, and thinking critically. It will introduce students to the appropriate available resources to achieve these aims and help them to understand how coursework is evaluated. Students will learn to recognize and apply transferable skills that will have value in a post-academic environment, preparing the department's graduates to make the most of their time at university and preparing them for life after their studies.

AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

- To introduce students to a range of research skills
- To improve essay and project writing skills
- To learn how to work in a team environment
- To develop public speaking skills
- To encourage critical and analytical skills

GENERAL LEARNING OUTCOMES

On successful completion of this course, students will have developed skills of:

- Writing an academic essay
- Working in a team

- Speaking in the public
- Thinking critically and analyzing topics related to political science and international relations

On successful completion of this course, students will have knowledge on:

- Engaging with the issues in political science international relations from an academic and professional perspective
- Working dynamics in the field of political science and international relations
- Writing projects and campaigns related to political science and international relations

RELATIONSHIP WITH OTHER COURSES

This is an introductory course in political science and international relations that provides a practical basis for skills that enable the students to engage with other courses in political science and international relations and other relevant social science disciplines and help students to develop skills that may be necessary for these courses.

LEARNING/TEACHING METHOD

Lectures, class discussions, class presentations, project/campaign designs, assignments, reading materials, lecture notes, other materials on the web, and assessment in exams.

METHOD OF ASSESSMENT

Midterm Examination	30%
Final Examination	35%
Project Design	15%
Political Campaign Design	15%
Attendance and Participation	5%

TOTAL	100%

COURSE REQUIREMENTS

Mid-term & Final Examination: The two exams may include questions in multiple-choice, open-ended essay, fill in the blanks, or true/false format. The final exam will include all topics.

Project Design: Students will be divided into groups of roughly equal numbers. Students will be asked to design a project based on one of the issues/topics that was provided by the instructor. Students will be expected to apply the knowledge that they gained about project writing in Week 5. This component will be out of 15 points. 10 points will be dedicated to the project design presentation in the class in Week 6. The remaining 5 points will be dedicated to the project design report in a written format for each group member (200 words, Times New Roman 12, 1,5 spacing on MS Word Format), individual written reports will be submitted in Week 9 via LMS Moodle.

Political Campaign Design: Students will be divided into groups of roughly equal numbers. Students will be asked to design a political campaign based on one of the issues/topics that was provided by the instructor. Students will be expected to apply the knowledge that they gained about political advertising and campaign in Weeks 13-14. This component will be out of 15 points. 10 points will be dedicated to the campaign design presentation in the class in Week 15. The remaining 5 points will be dedicated to the campaign design report in a written format for each group member (200 words, Times New Roman 12, 1,5 spacing on MS Word Format), individual written reports will be submitted in Week 16 via LMS Moodle.

Attendance and Participation: Students are required to attend class, but also to actively participate in class discussions. 5 points for this component will be given based on student-class engagement.

SCHEDULE AND READINGS

WEEK	TOPIC	READINGS
Week 1-2 (15 - 23 Feb)	Introduction to the Course & Skills for Social Sciences	This Course Outline & Shaw, Victor. "Essential social science skills in college and university education." <i>Contemporary Education</i> 72 no:1 (2002): 39-43.
Week 3 (26 Feb - 1 Mar)	Academic Writing	Baglione, Lisa A. <i>Writing a research paper in political science: A practical guide to inquiry, structure, and methods</i> . CQ Press, 2018. – Chapters 1 and 2.
Week 4 (4 - 8 Mar)	Public Speaking	Beebe, Steven A., and Susan J. Beebe. <i>Public speaking handbook</i> . Allyn & Bacon, 2010. – Chapter 6.
Week 5 (11 - 15 Mar)	Project Writing	Neibu, Besim. <i>Developing Skills of NGOs: Project Proposal Writing</i> . The Regional Environmental Center, 2002.
Week 6 (18 - 22 Mar)	Project Design	Project Design preparations and presentations.
Week 7 – 8 (25 Mar - 6 Apr)	Mid-term Examination Period	No class, no readings.
Week 9 (8 – 12 Apr)	Ramadan Holiday	No class, no readings. <u>*Submission of individual reports on Project Design, 11 April 2024, Thursday.</u>

Week 10 (15 - 19 Apr)	Policy Paper Writing	Young, Eoin, and Lisa Quinn. <i>Writing effective public policy papers</i> . Local Government and Public Service Reform Initiative, 2002. – Chapters 4 and 5.
Week 11 (22 – 26 Apr)	Civil Society Activism	Green, Duncan. <i>How change happens</i> . Oxford University Press, 2016. – Chapter 9.
Week 12 (29 Apr – 3 May)	Volunteerism	Wu, Huiting. "Social impact of volunteerism." <i>Points of Light Institute</i> . 2011.
Week 13 (6 - 10 May)	Political Communication I: Political Advertising	McNair, Brian. <i>An introduction to political communication</i> . Routledge, 2017. – Chapter 6.
Week 14 (13 - 17 May)	Political Communication II: Political Campaigning	McNair, Brian. <i>An introduction to political communication</i> . Routledge, 2017. – Chapter 7.
Week 15 (20 - 24 May)	Political Campaign Design	Political Campaign Design preparations and presentations.
Week 16 (27 - 31 May)	Revision	Revising material for the final examination. <u>*Submission of individual reports on Campaign Design, 31 May 2024, Friday.</u>
Week 17 – 18 (3 – 14 Jun)	Final Examination Period	No class, no readings.

COURSE POLICIES

1. Regular class/online attendance is required. In case of failing to attend at least 60% of the scheduled class meetings or not attending midterm or final exams may result in receiving NG.
2. Exams will include questions from assigned readings and class discussions as described in this Course Outline.
3. You will be given one midterm exam during the midterm exam period and a final examination at the end of the semester. The final exam will include **all** topics.
4. **Make-up Policy:** You are expected to take the exams on the days on which they are given. Mid-Term and Final Make-up Examinations options will be available only to those students who have an extenuating circumstance. These students should submit their reasons in the form of a formal e-mail within **3 days** after examination e.g. the submission of a valid medical report. Make-up examinations will not be announced publicly, only students who contacted the instructor will be informed about the details. No make-up will be given for components other than examinations; including Project Design and Political Campaign Design presentations.
5. The use of artificial intelligence sources is **forbidden** for any examination and assignment, verbal or written.
6. Mobile phones should be turned off during class meetings, examinations, and presentations.
7. The accepted similarity rate for the written assignments for this course is 20%. 1 point will be reduced for each additional similarity rate percentage.
8. Late submissions **are not** allowed for Individual Reports on Project Design and Political Campaign Design assignments.
9. Please note that this course outline may be subject to change.
10. **Important Dates:**
 - 18-22 March 2024: Project Design and Presentations
 - 11 April 2024: Submission of Individual Reports on Project Design and Presentation
 - 20-24 May 2024: Political Campaign Design and Presentations
 - 31 May 2024: Submission of Individual Reports on Political Campaign Design and Presentation

GRADING SCALE

A	100 – 85	C	62 – 60
A -	84 – 80	C -	59 – 57
B +	79 – 75	D +	56 – 54
B	74 – 70	D	53 – 50
B -	69 – 66	D -	49 – 45
C +	65 – 63	F	44 – 0

Important note:

Academic Honesty: Plagiarism will not be tolerated under any circumstances. Plagiarism is intentionally failing to give credit to sources used in writing regardless of whether they are published or unpublished. Plagiarism and any kind of cheating in exams is a disciplinary offense and will be dealt with accordingly. **Note that “CUT AND PASTE” IS A FORM OF PLAGIARISM.**